



9-28-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oCCJb2-LTSc
Publication Date	2021-09-29T10:37:51Z
Target Category	mcs

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Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees was called to order by the presiding officer on Tuesday, September 28, 2021 [00:03:52](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Well, and Board President Mr. Williams.
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams (Board President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The meeting opened with a moment of silence in memory of Carol Little, who served the Central family for approximately 25 years and passed away on September 21 [00:02:42](#).
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was recited by all attendees [00:03:36](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:20 Presentation & Report: North Side Middle School**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Grimm, Principal of North Side Middle School.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Grimm presented an update on North Side Middle School, highlighting an in-person enrollment of 575<U+2013>579 students (the largest since the 2016-17 school year), a staff of 36 teachers, 12 support staff, and active academic and athletic programs. He detailed academic goals targeting significant score increases in ELA and math, supported by partnerships with Ball State University and NIET. Additionally, Mr. Grimm introduced the school's "Titan TV" club, which has grown to 80 student members under the direction of secondary teacher of the year Isaac Dennison.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board action required.
- **00:27:53 Presentation & Recognition: Muncie Visitors Bureau & Muncie Rotary Club**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representative of the Muncie Visitors Bureau / Muncie Rotary Club (former interim principal).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The presenter highlighted a longstanding partnership with the Delaware County Fair and Muncie Central High School, where athletic teams and student groups staff the main gate to raise funds. Checks of \$450 each were distributed to representatives of the girls golf team, national honor society, muncie central girls jv basketball team (two nights, totaling \$900), tennis team, and girls soccer team.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational recognition; no formal board action required.
- **00:44:32 Motion to Reorder Agenda (Dialogue of the Board)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President Mr. Williams / Dr. Kwakowski.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** President Williams requested a motion to move the "Dialogue of the Board" presentation ahead of the consent agenda to address statewide and national discussions regarding curriculum, social-emotional learning, and historical perspectives.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:45:18](#).
- **01:18:50 Consent Agenda Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine consent agenda items were presented to the board for review.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:19:05](#).

- **01:19:10 Financial Report & Fiscal Health Indicators**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The financial officer presented fiscal health indicators utilizing Forecast5 software, showing positive trends in total cash balances (approx. \$27.9 million), revenue versus expenditures, and fund balances across the education, operation, and rainy day funds. The report also detailed the impact of property tax caps (circuit breakers) in Muncie compared to peer school districts across the North Central Conference.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:26:34](#).
 - **01:26:51 Teacher Appreciation Grant (TAG) Policy Adoption**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dialyn Phelps (Human Resources / Administration).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Ms. Phelps presented the annual Teacher Appreciation Grant (TAG) distribution policy as required by the Indiana Department of Education. The policy ensures grant funds are distributed to teachers rated effective or highly effective, with highly effective teachers receiving 25% more than effective teachers.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:28:28](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:32:34 Julie Schneider** (Teacher, Muncie Central High School)
 - Spoke regarding a recent teacher release-time meeting with Ball State University faculty, praising the collaborative networking between high school and university departments and proposing streamlined off-campus visits for dual-credit and AP students.
- **00:35:10 Phil Boltz** (Community Organizer, Parent, and Educator)
 - Praised the high ability program at East Washington Academy and announced an upcoming online panel event hosted by Muncie Resists on October 7 addressing critical race theory, social-emotional learning, and educational practice.
- **00:37:29 Jim Borgman** (Community Volunteer and Coach)
 - Spoke in strong support of social-emotional learning, emphasizing that educators must recognize diverse student backgrounds and emotional needs to ensure student success.
- **00:39:44 Jim Arnold** (Parent, Concerned Citizen, and Taxpayer)
 - Read portions of the "Parent Education Bill of Rights" published by Indiana Attorney General Todd Rokita and questioned the board regarding a prior meeting's public record video availability and pre-meeting sign-up requirements.
- **00:42:35 Cameron Grubbs** (Community Member)
 - Commended the school board for mask policies and safety examples in Delaware County, and suggested accessibility improvements at school security entrances for

deaf or hard-of-hearing visitors (such as visual cues and remote door-opening capabilities).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Dr. Kwakowski reported that Beth Buehler (East Washington Academy teacher) successfully secured a community foundation grant for her high ability program. She also noted that principals engaged in professional development regarding state and federal statutes during parent-teacher conference early-release days.
- Board President Williams addressed an inquiry regarding a previous meeting's livestream video, explaining that a substitute technician experienced technical difficulties during that session.

- **Adjournment:**

- Official adjournment disposition: Approved by Voice Vote **01:30:22**.
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